

The 8 patterns, *mapped*

Diagrams show the **shape**, where you and the follower start, travel, and land, plus the count and the one lead cue that matters.

What a still *can't* show is the lead and timing of a moving partner. Two moves below are flagged ► [see it moving](#), treat the picture there as a map, not a lesson.

HOW TO READ THESE

L Gold disc, you, the leader

F Teal ring, the follower

→ **Dashed arrow**, travel path across the floor

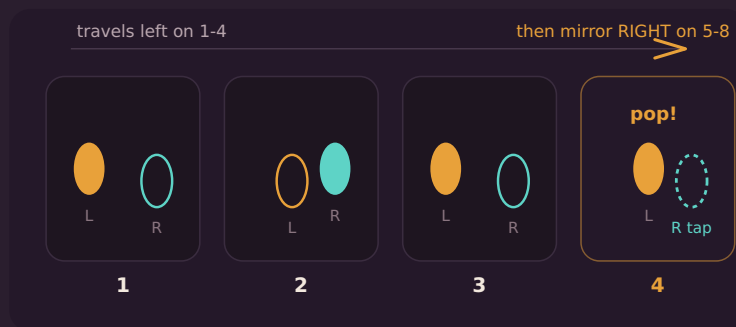
↻ **Curved arrow**, a turn / rotation on the spot



L is gold, R is teal, always · **solid** = weight on it · **hollow** = tap / no weight

01 The basic

count 1 2 3 4 · 5 6 7 8 4 & 8 = hip pop



LEAD

Stay soft in the knees the whole time, the hip pop on 4 and 8 is a *result* of bending and straightening the knees, not something you force from the hips.

Same rhythm gives you the two variations: step nearly **in place** to hold your spot, or step **forward-and-back** to travel, swapping between all three is most of a song.

02 Cross-body lead

timing 8-count, prep, travel across, resolve · your glue between everything

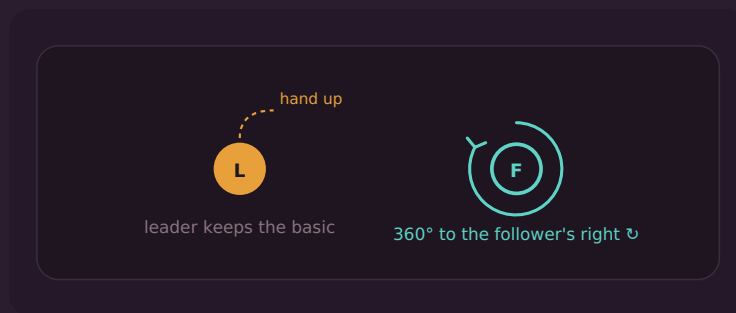


LEAD

The leader opens the lane and pivots out of the way, giving a clear forward lead so the follower walks straight across the slot. Both dancers end facing each other again, spots swapped.

03 Follower's right turn

timing led over a 4-count (e.g. prep on 4, turn 5-6-7, land on 8)

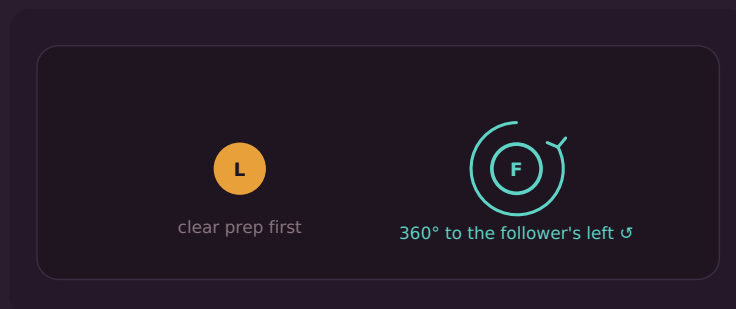


LEAD

The leader raises the left hand into a loose ceiling and preps a beat early, so the turn is expected. The follower spot-turns underneath. Guide the arm, never crank it.

04 Follower's left turn

timing same 4-count feel, turning the other way

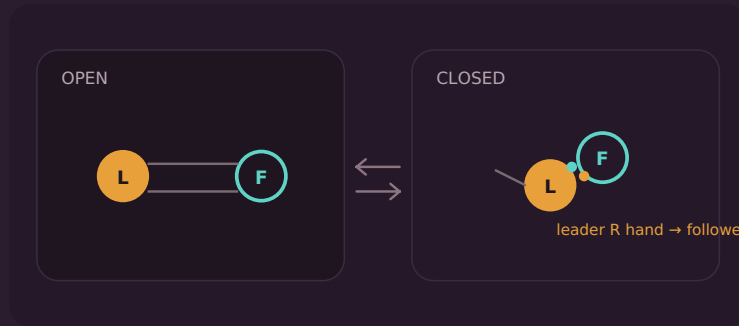


LEAD

Prep in the opposite direction first, then indicate the turn clearly, the left turn feels less natural to a follower, so the signal has to be a touch stronger and earlier.

05 Closed ↔ open

timing over any basic, this is how you change the "room" you're dancing in



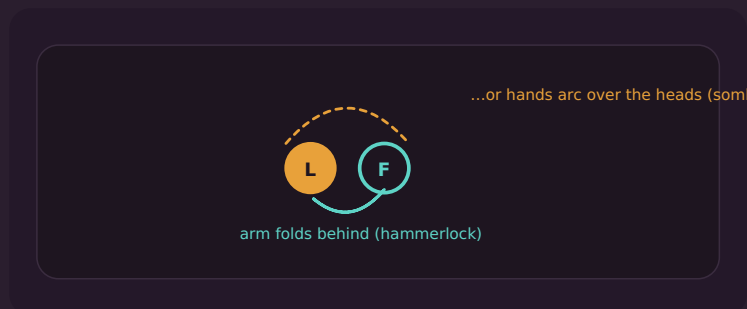
LEAD

The leader's right hand sits on the follower's shoulder blade, left hand out to the side, bodies close and slightly offset. Lead *in* to close the frame, and open back up to send the follower out to arm's length.

From closed you can raise the left hand and lead a simple underarm turn, a clean, high-value move that costs you nothing new.

06 Armlock / sombrero

timing a turn with a wrapped exit



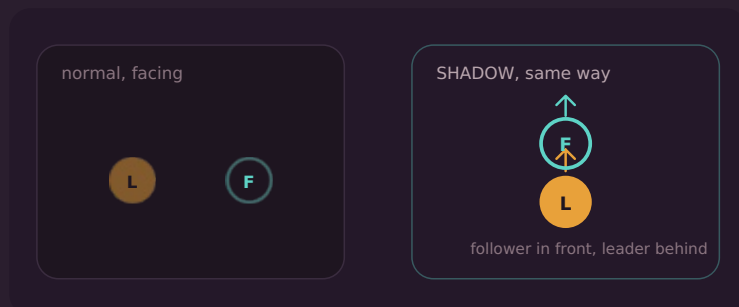
LEAD

Lead a turn and, instead of releasing, let the arm wrap: either folding behind the small of the follower's back, or both hands arcing up and over the heads like putting on a hat.

► see it moving, the entry is all in the timing

07 Shadow position

timing led out of a turn that doesn't resolve to face



LEAD

Lead a turn but keep the follower turned away instead of resolving to face. The follower ends directly in front, both dancers facing the same direction, with the frame over the follower's shoulders.

08 Body roll / wave

timing on a pause or a slow phrase, yours alone, no partner



LEAD

Initiate at the chest, let the movement roll down through your ribs, stomach and hips in one continuous wave. This is styling, it's what makes you read as a dancer.

► see it moving, drill it slow in the mirror first

Master these eight and you can dance any song. Everything else is decoration you add on top.